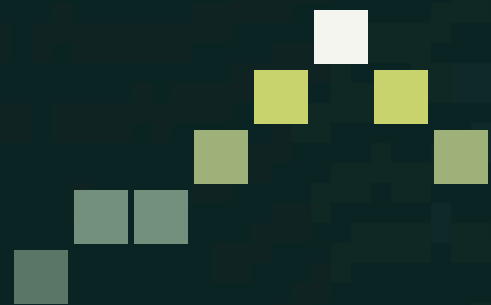


IDENTITY SYSTEM

ROUND 3 — FOR REVIEW · OCTOBER 2026

WORKING DRAFT · NOT FOR RELEASE



HCO

HIGH COUNTRY OBSERVATIONS

01 INTRODUCTION

The mountain, measured.

HCO helps farmers, ranchers and agricultural businesses understand their land and their operation. The identity works the way the work does: observe first, then report clearly. The symbol is a measured section of terrain. The letters are drawn on the same pixel grid. The colours report elevation.

01 Measured, not drawn

The symbol is eight samples of a real reading of the terrain model, not a picture of a mountain.

02 One module, one pen

A sample, a letter stroke and the layout unit are the same size: 1M. Letters are drawn in half-module pixels.

CONTENTS

01	Introduction	p. 02
02	Origin	p. 03
03	Symbol	p. 05
04	Wordmark	p. 06
05	Signature	p. 07
06	Numerals	p. 08
07	Family and use	p. 09
08	Colour	p. 12
09	Typography	p. 14
10	Graphic language	p. 16
11	Imagery	p. 17
12	Applications	p. 18
13	Decisions	p. 24

03 Colour is data

Colour encodes elevation or status. It is never decoration, and it lives on the dark ground.

02 ORIGIN

Every mark begins
as a measurement.

We cut a section through the terrain, averaged the surface into eight samples and rounded each to a whole module. The result is the symbol. It is not a drawing of a mountain; it is a reading of one.

01 TERRAIN

An illustrative model, 96 × 96 samples.

02 SECTION

One cut, line A–A, across the summit.

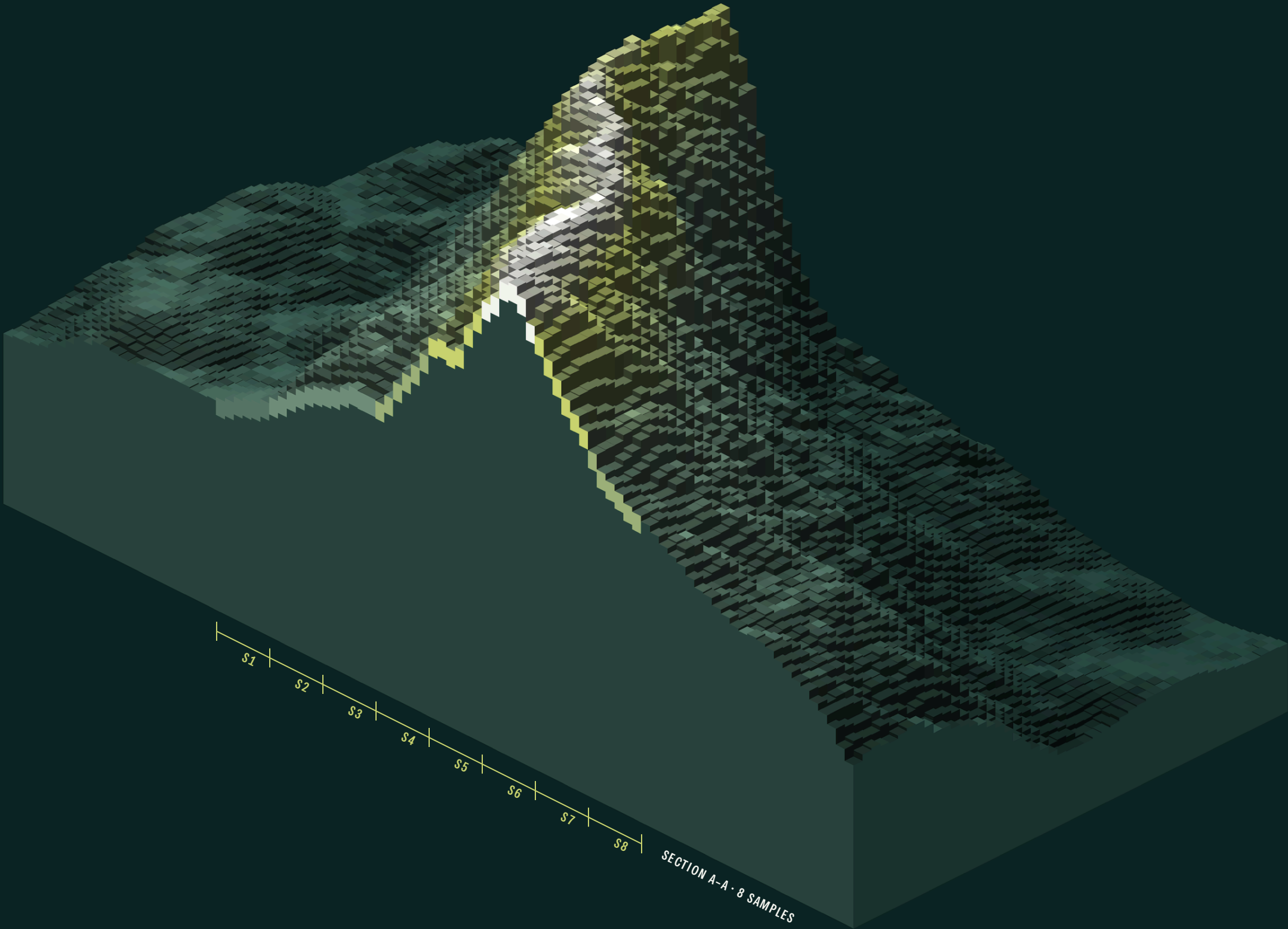
03 SAMPLES

The surface averaged into eight intervals.

04 SYMBOL

Each mean rounded to whole modules: 0 1 1 2 3 4 3 2.

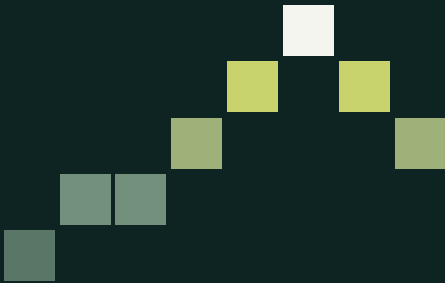
Procedural terrain for illustration. No real location is depicted or implied.



02 FROM SECTION TO SYMBOL

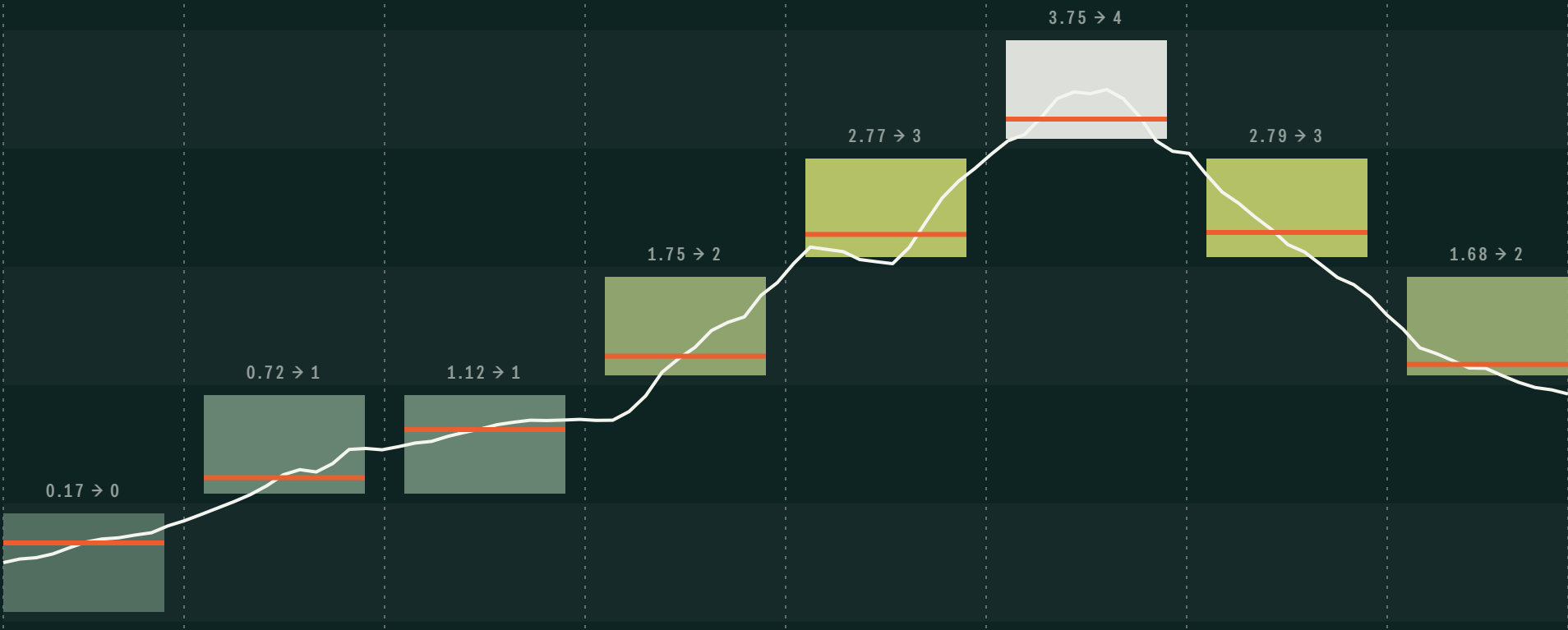
Read, average, round.

The continuous surface (white) is averaged over eight equal intervals (orange). Each mean is scaled to five levels and rounded. Nothing is adjusted by eye.



RESULT · 8 × 5 MODULES

SECTION A-A · CONTINUOUS SURFACE

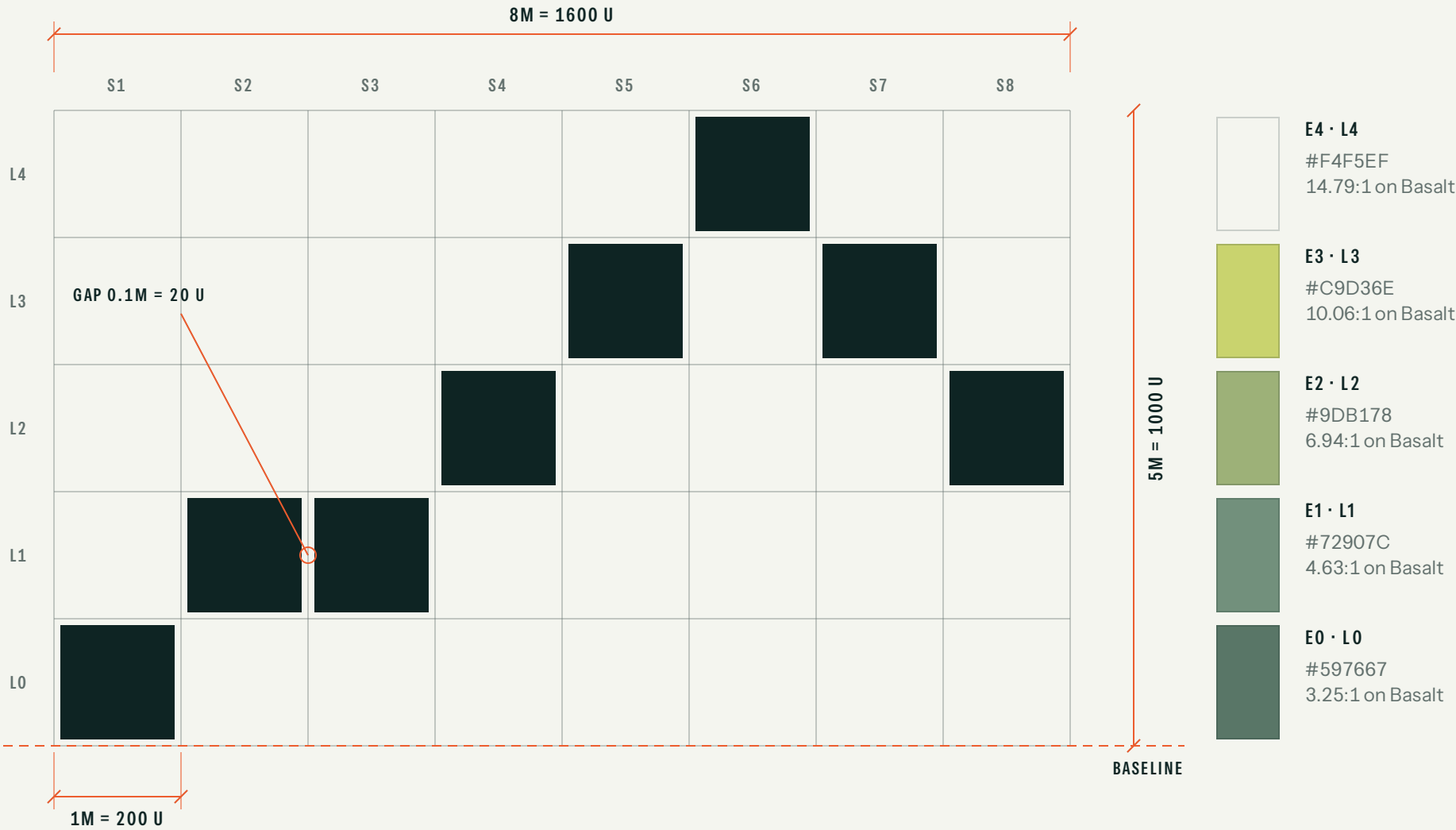


SAMPLE	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8
MEAN, NORMALISED	0.042	0.179	0.281	0.437	0.694	0.938	0.698	0.419
× 4 LEVELS	0.17	0.72	1.12	1.75	2.77	3.75	2.79	1.68
LEVEL	0	1	1	2	3	4	3	2
RAMP STEP	E0	E1	E1	E2	E3	E4	E3	E2

03 SYMBOL

Ridgeline. Eight samples, one grid.

One cell per sample, standing on the baseline at its measured level. Colour follows level through the elevation ramp, E0 low to E4 summit.



01 FIXED SEQUENCE

0 1 1 2 3 4 3 2. The samples are data and are never redrawn or reordered.

02 SQUARE CELLS

Cells are square, unrounded and unoutlined. The 0.1M gap closes to zero at pixel sizes.

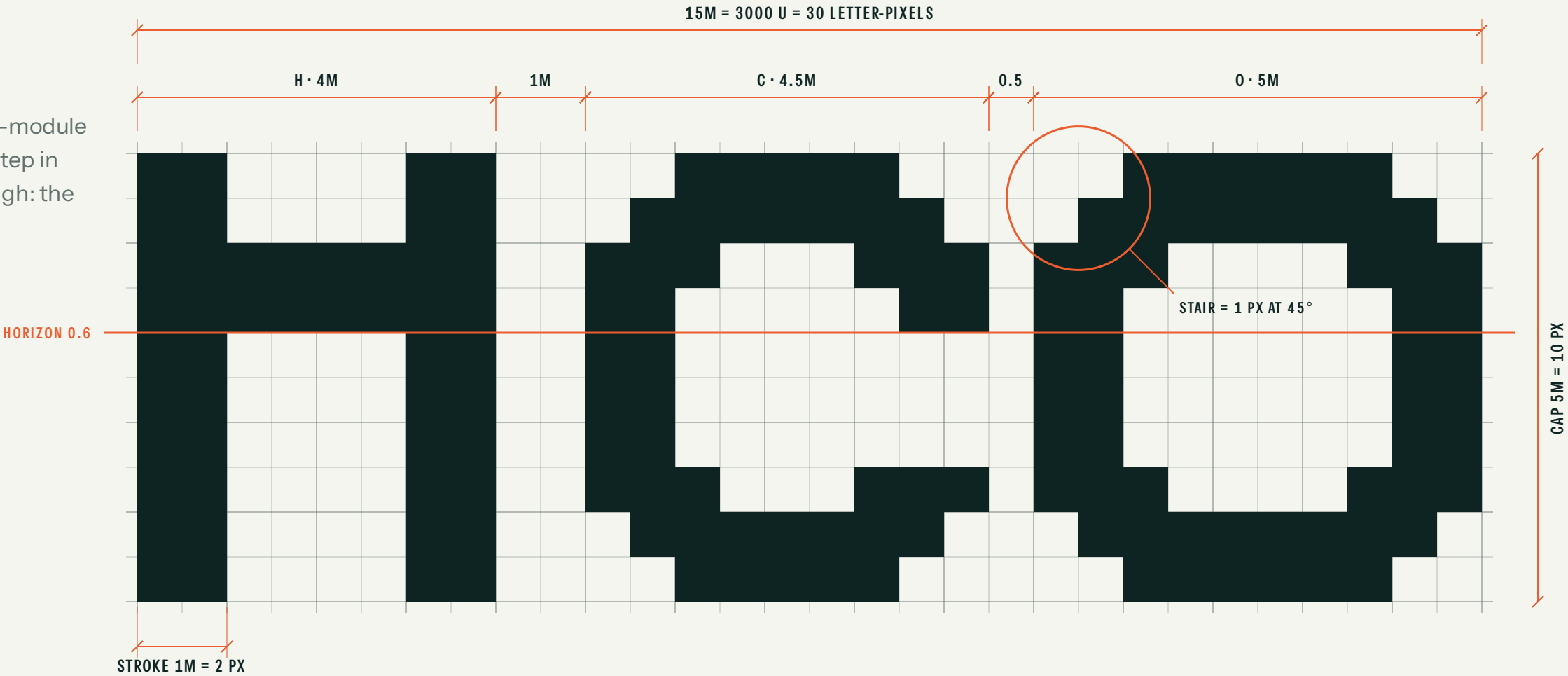
03 COLOUR ON DARK

The full-colour symbol sits on Basalt or Moss only. On light grounds use the one-colour version.

04 WORDMARK

HCO, drawn in pixels.

A custom wordmark on a grid of half-module pixels. Stems are two pixels, curves step in single pixels, and the crossbar sits high: the horizon seen from high ground.



01 ONE PEN

Every stroke is 2 px = 1M, the width of one sample in the symbol.

02 ONE HORIZON

The crossbar and the C’s upper jaw end on one line, 0.6 of the cap height above the baseline.

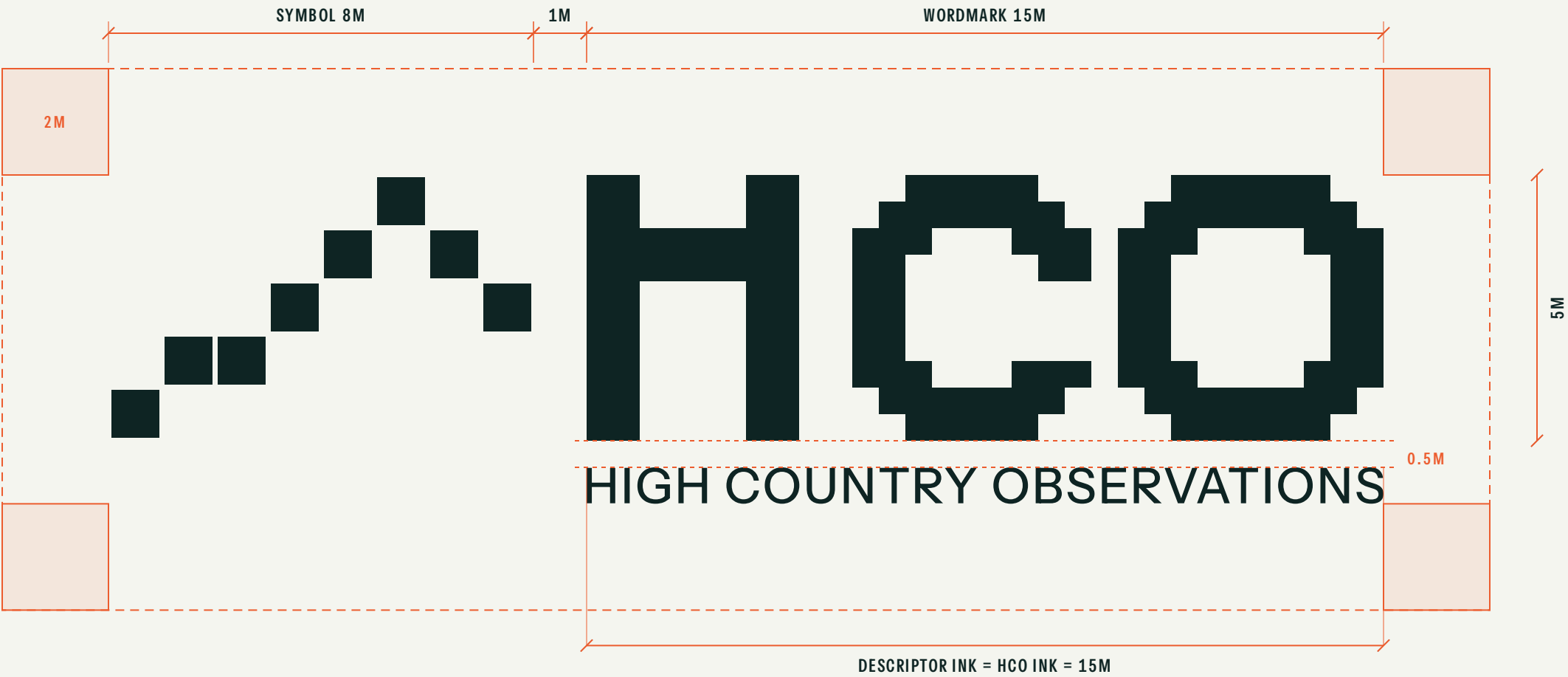
03 NO OVERSHOOT

Pixels do not overshoot: H, C and O share one cap line and one baseline. Spacing is 2 px and 1 px.

05 SIGNATURE

Symbol and wordmark, 24 × 5 modules.

The symbol and HCO share cap line and baseline, one module apart. The descriptor is fitted to the ink width of HCO and hangs one letter-pixel below it.



01 CLEAR SPACE

2M on every side, measured from the ink. Nothing enters it: not text, not edges, not imagery detail.

02 DESCRIPTOR

High Country Observations, tracked uppercase, outlined. It is part of the artwork, never retyped.

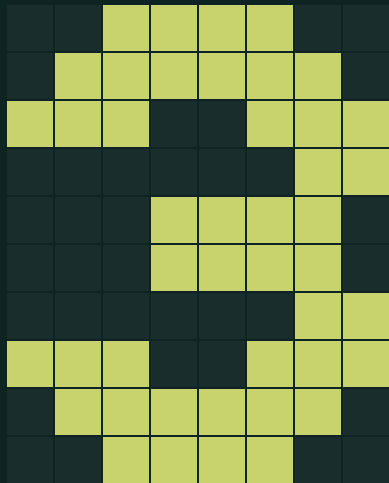
03 NAME CHECK

“Group” or “Consulting” is not shown until the client confirms the trading name.

06 NUMERALS

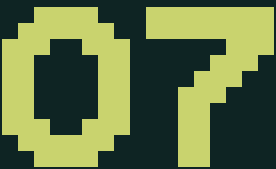
Figures from the same pen.

Ten bespoke pixel figures for the numbers that matter: sections, observations and key data. They are tabular, so columns align. Never use them for running text.

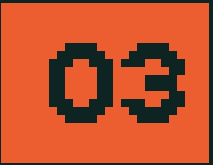


CONSTRUCTION · 8 × 10 PX · TABULAR

SECTION NUMBER



OBSERVATION MARKER

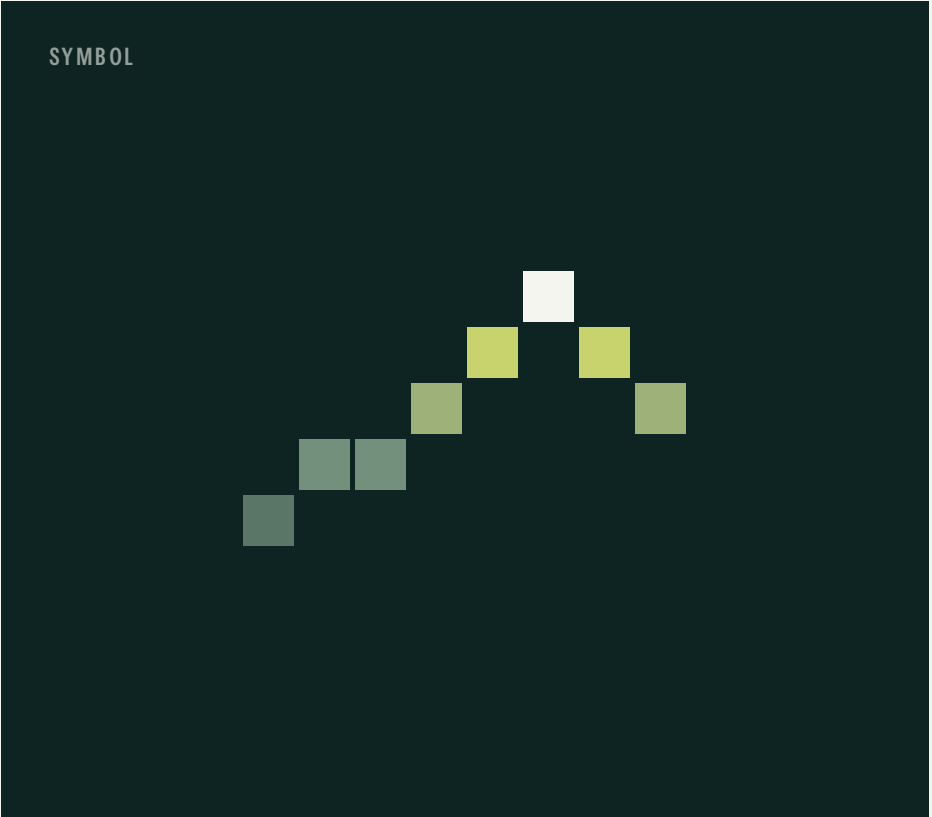


KEY FIGURE



07 FAMILY

One signature, five configurations.



07 SCALE

Sharp from 16 px upward.

01 PRIMARY

Minimum 200 px wide on screen, 45 mm in print.
Below this the descriptor falls under 6 pt.

02 COMPACT

Minimum 96 px, 20 mm. Use it when the descriptor would be illegible.

03 SYMBOL

Minimum 16 px, 6 mm. Below 48 px use the pixel-snapped files: whole-pixel cells, no gaps.

TRUE SIZE



PRIMARY · 200 PX



COMPACT · 96 PX



180 PX



48 PX



32 PX

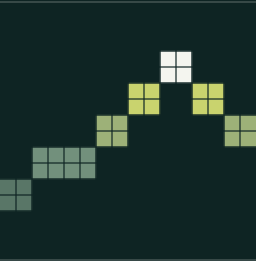


24 PX

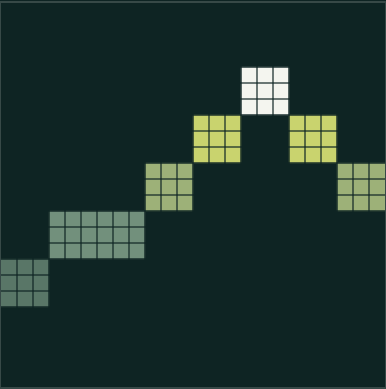


16 PX

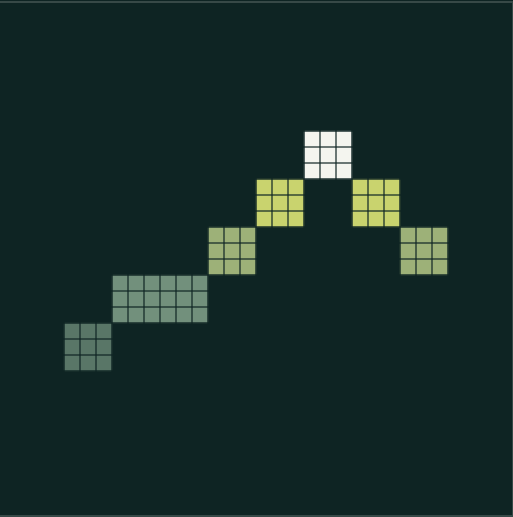
ENLARGED × 8 · PIXEL-SNAPPED FAVICONS



16 PX · CELL 2 PX · NO GAP



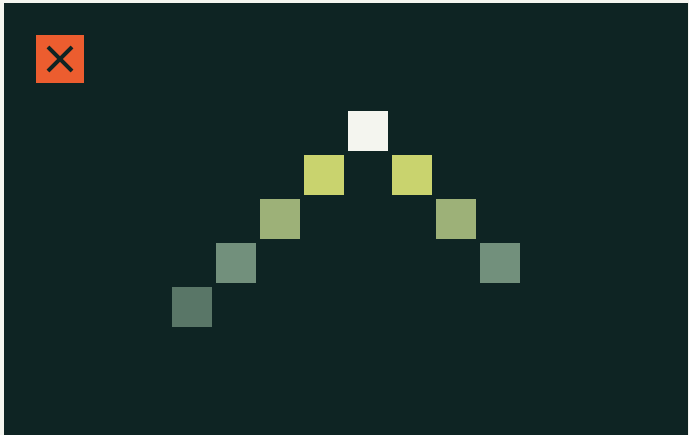
24 PX · CELL 3 PX · NO GAP



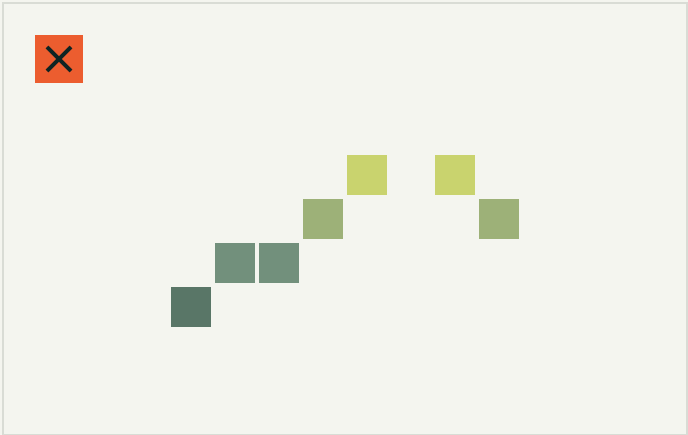
32 PX · CELL 3 PX · NO GAP

07 RULES

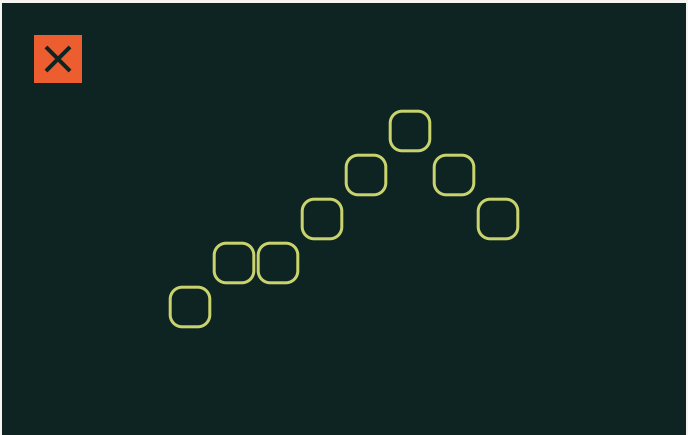
Eight things the mark never does.



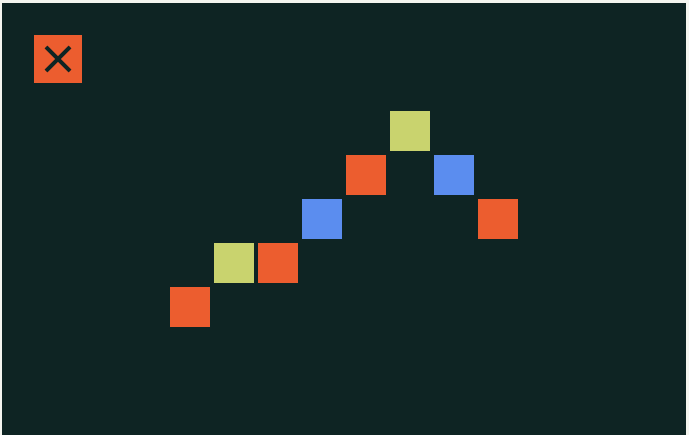
01 NEVER
redraw, smooth or reorder the samples.



02 NEVER
use the full-colour symbol on light grounds.



03 NEVER
round, outline, bevel or shadow the cells.



04 NEVER
recolour cells outside the elevation ramp.



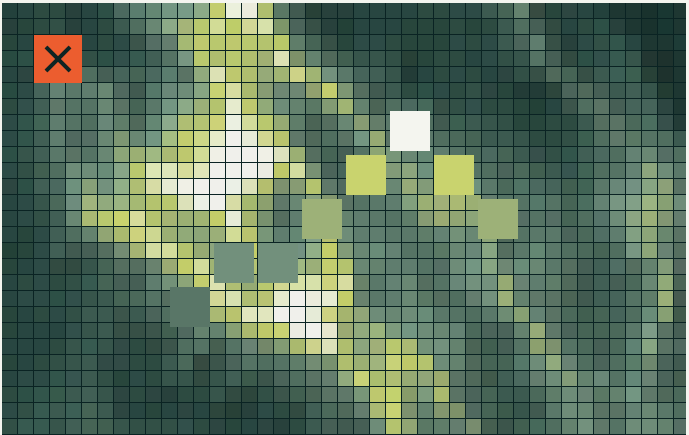
05 NEVER
stretch, condense or rotate the signature.



06 NEVER
retype HCO in a typeface; use the artwork.



07 NEVER
add a drawn mountain, sun or horizon.

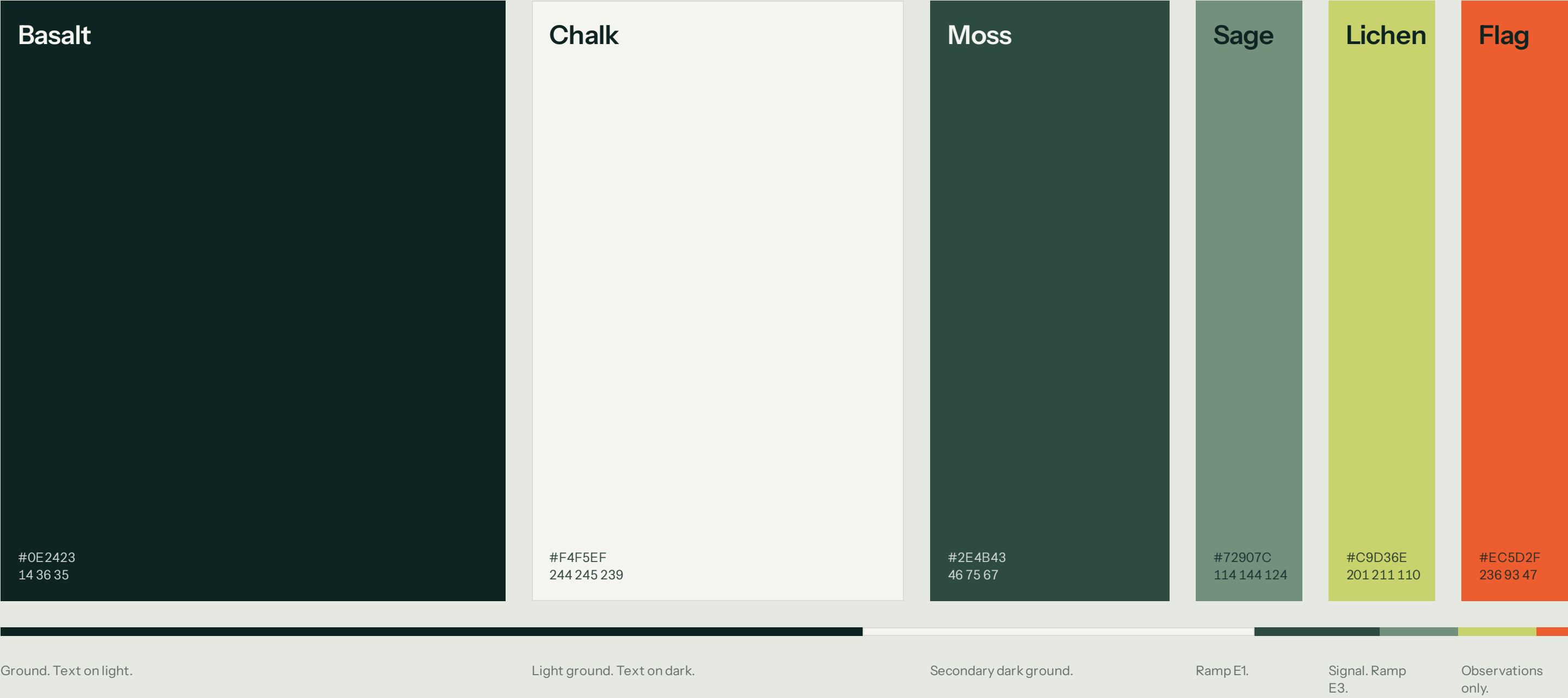


08 NEVER
set the mark over busy imagery without a quiet field.

08 COLOUR

A Basalt ground. Colour as signal.

The bar below the swatches shows the share of a typical layout: Basalt 55, Chalk 25, Moss 8, Sage 5, Lichen 5, Flag 2. Print values (CMYK, Pantone) are matched on press proofs at Stage 2.



08 ELEVATION RAMP

Five steps, even to the eye.

			ON BASALT		ON MOSS	ON CHALK
	E4 #F4F5EF OKLab L 0.97 14.79:1 on Basalt	CHALK #F4F5EF	Aa 14.79:1 AAA		Aa 8.69:1 AAA	
	E3 #C9D36E OKLab L 0.84 10.06:1 on Basalt	LICHEN #C9D36E	Aa 10.06:1 AAA		Aa 5.91:1 AA	Aa 1.47:1 Not for text
	E2 #9DB178 OKLab L 0.73 6.94:1 on Basalt	E2 #9DB178	Aa 6.94:1 AA		Aa 4.08:1 Large / graphics	Aa 2.13:1 Not for text
	E1 #72907C OKLab L 0.62 4.63:1 on Basalt	SAGE #72907C	Aa 4.63:1 AA		Aa 2.72:1 Not for text	Aa 3.19:1 Large / graphics
	E0 #597667 OKLab L 0.54 3.25:1 on Basalt	FLAG #EC5D2F	Aa 4.77:1 AA		Aa 2.80:1 Not for text	Aa 3.10:1 Large / graphics
		INK 2 #959F9A	Aa 5.95:1 AA		Aa 3.50:1 Large / graphics	Aa 2.49:1 Not for text
		BASALT #0E2423			Aa 1.70:1 Not for text	Aa 14.79:1 AAA
		STONE #62706D	Aa 3.13:1 Large / graphics		Aa 1.84:1 Not for text	Aa 4.72:1 AA

Bar length = OKLab lightness.

WCAG 2.2 contrast, computed from sRGB values. Text needs 4.5:1 (AA); large text and graphics need 3:1. E0 is for graphics only. Basalt on Lichen measures 10.06:1.

09 TYPOGRAPHY

Instrument Sans for
everything people read.

Aa

A contemporary grotesk with a condensed width for labels. Pixel letters are kept for the wordmark and figures; text is always set in Instrument Sans.

Licence: SIL Open Font License 1.1, which permits print, web and app use and embedding. Final typeface to be confirmed at Stage 2.

Observe first.	REGULAR · 400
Observe first.	MEDIUM · 500
Observe first.	SEMIBOLD · 600
Observe first.	BOLD · 700
FIELD INTELLIGENCE	CONDENSED · 600

PAIRING



Priority areas

Pixel figures mark the number; Instrument Sans carries the words.

CHARACTER SET (EXCERPT)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 & @ € £ % () → ·

09 TYPE SYSTEM

Every size and line-height is a multiple of 8 px. Sample lines use the client’s own words from the existing flyer.

One scale on an 8 px baseline.

DISPLAY
112 / 112 · -3.5% · 600

HEADING 1
72 / 72 · -3% · 600

HEADING 2
40 / 48 · -2% · 600

HEADING 3
24 / 32 · -1% · 600

BODY LARGE
20 / 32 · 400

BODY
16 / 24 · 400

LABEL
12 / 16 · Condensed 600 · +11% caps

CAPTION
12 / 16 · 400

Field to report.
Start with the problem.
We actually show up.

Practical. Not theory.

Your operation comes first.

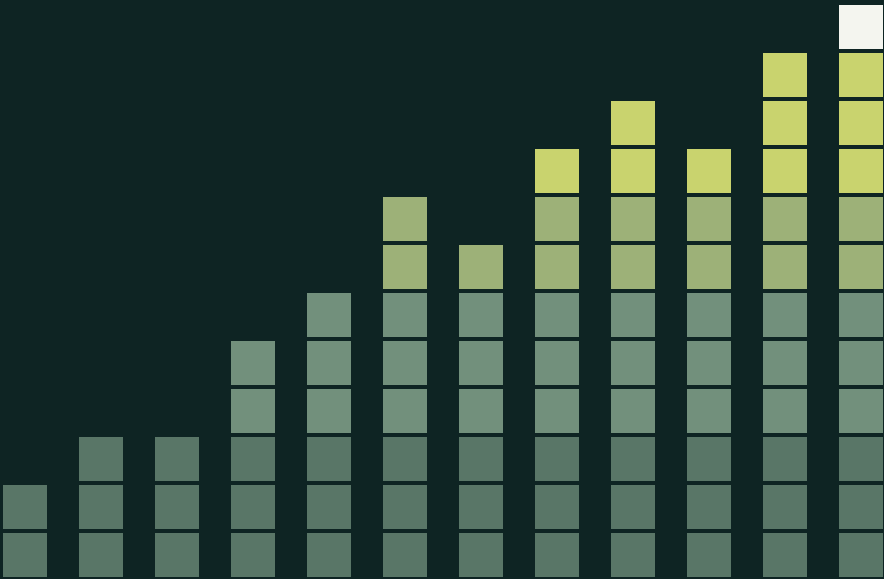
We show up, learn the operation, identify the issue, and give you practical options for what to do next.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · BUSINESS & OPERATIONS

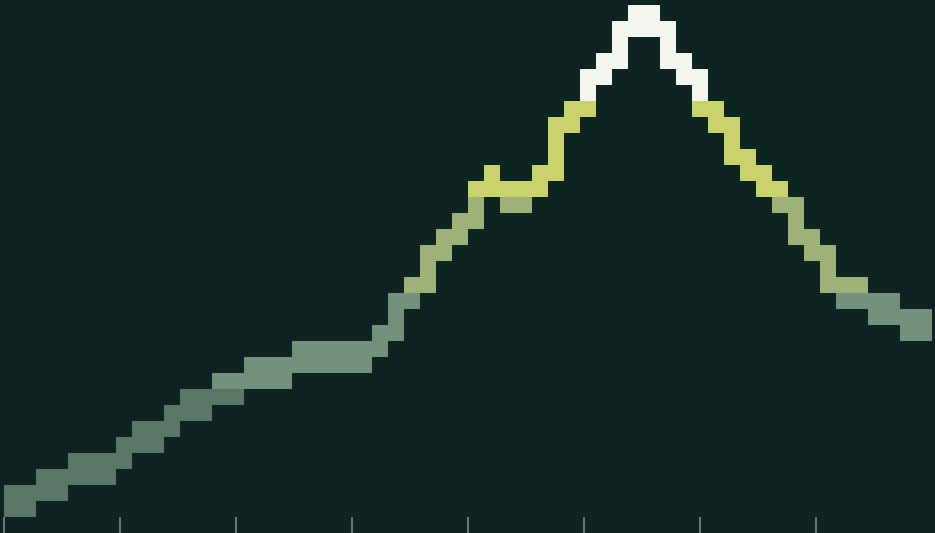
Figure 03 · Illustrative data, not survey results.

10 GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

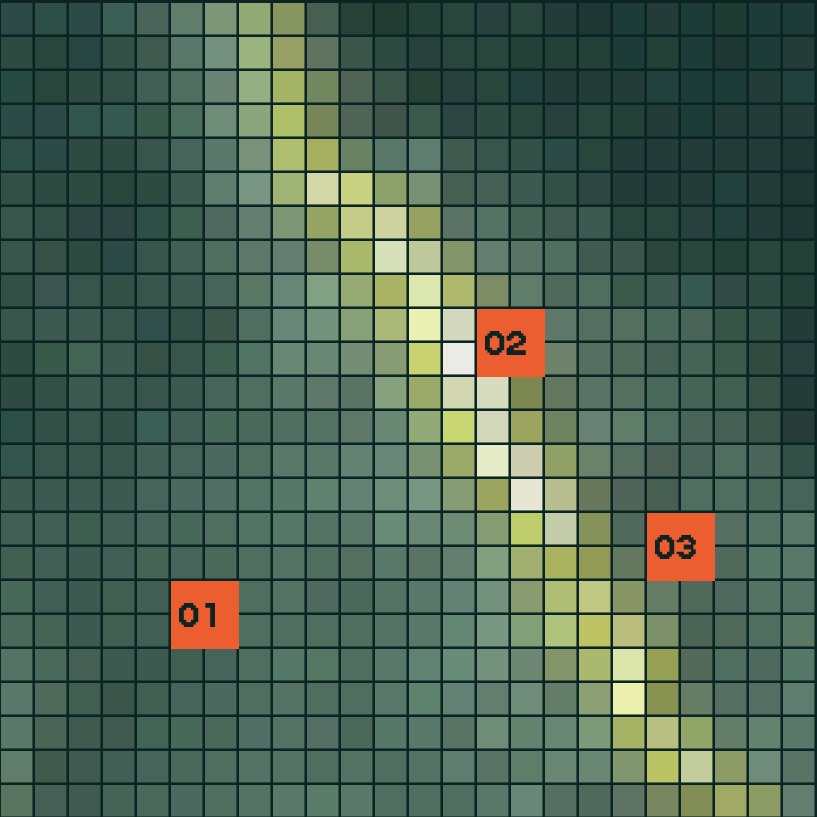
Samples, profiles and flags.



REPEAT VISITS · ILLUSTRATIVE COUNTS



SECTION A-A · 2-PX PEN · STAIRS OF 1 PX



01 SAMPLE

The cell is the unit of every chart, bullet and progress mark. Counts are stacked, never smoothed.

02 PROFILE

Lines are drawn with the wordmark's pen: two pixels thick, stepping in single pixels.

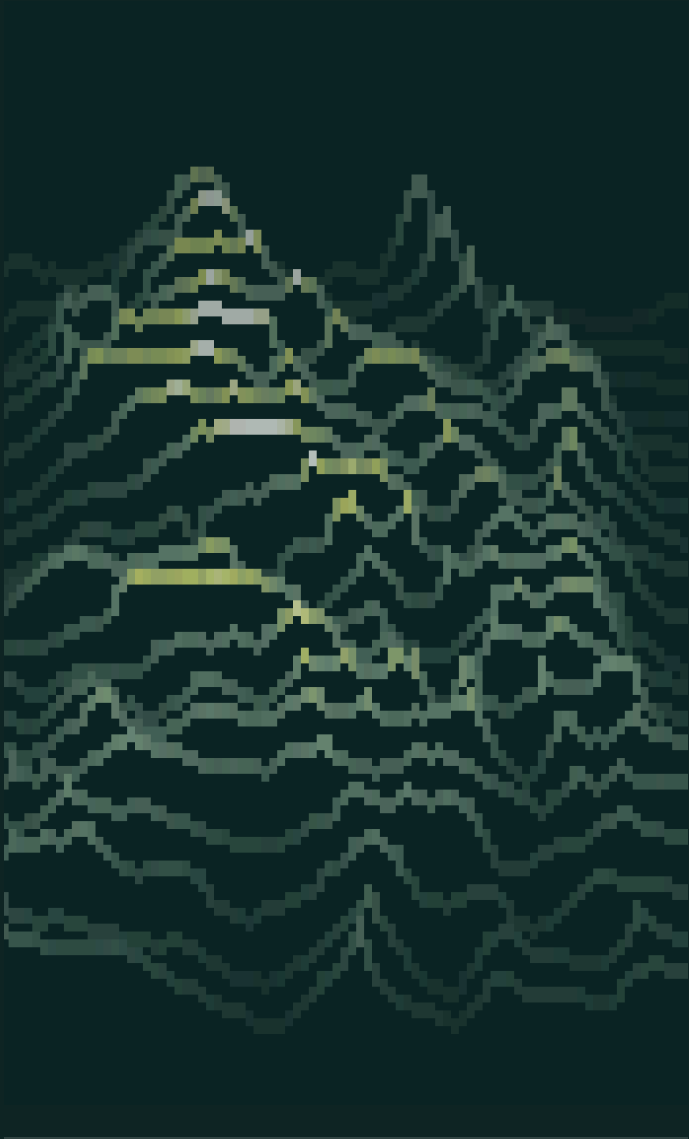
03 FLAG

Flag marks an observation, numbered in pixel figures. The same marker appears on maps and in the field.

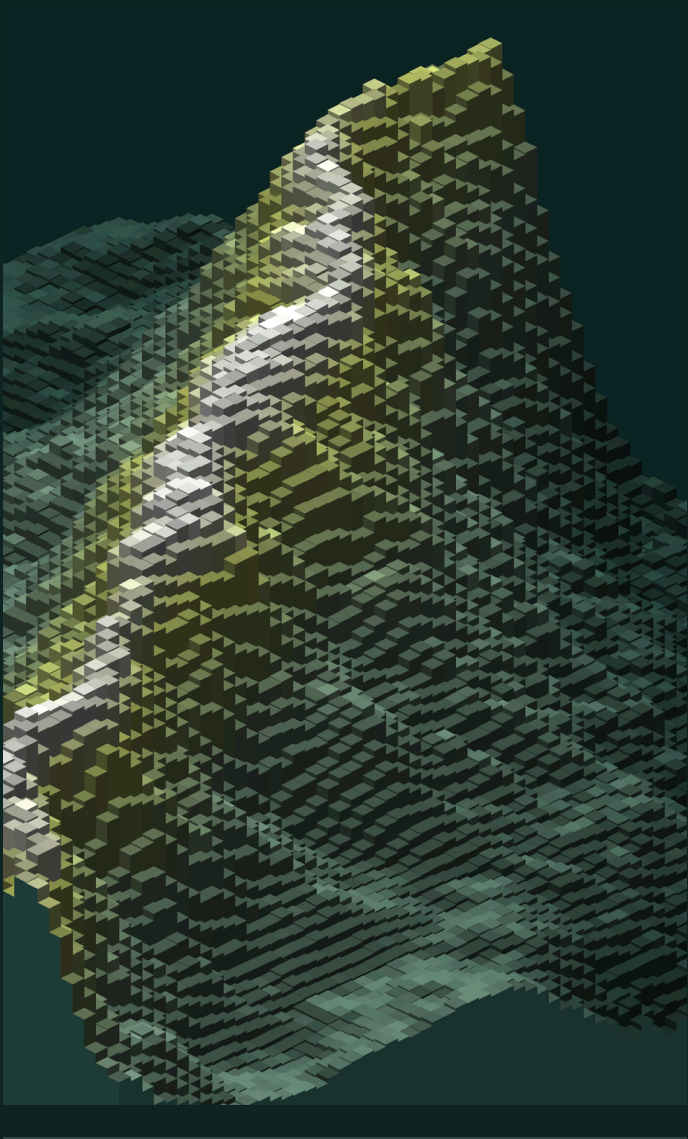
11 IMAGERY

One dataset, four ways of seeing.

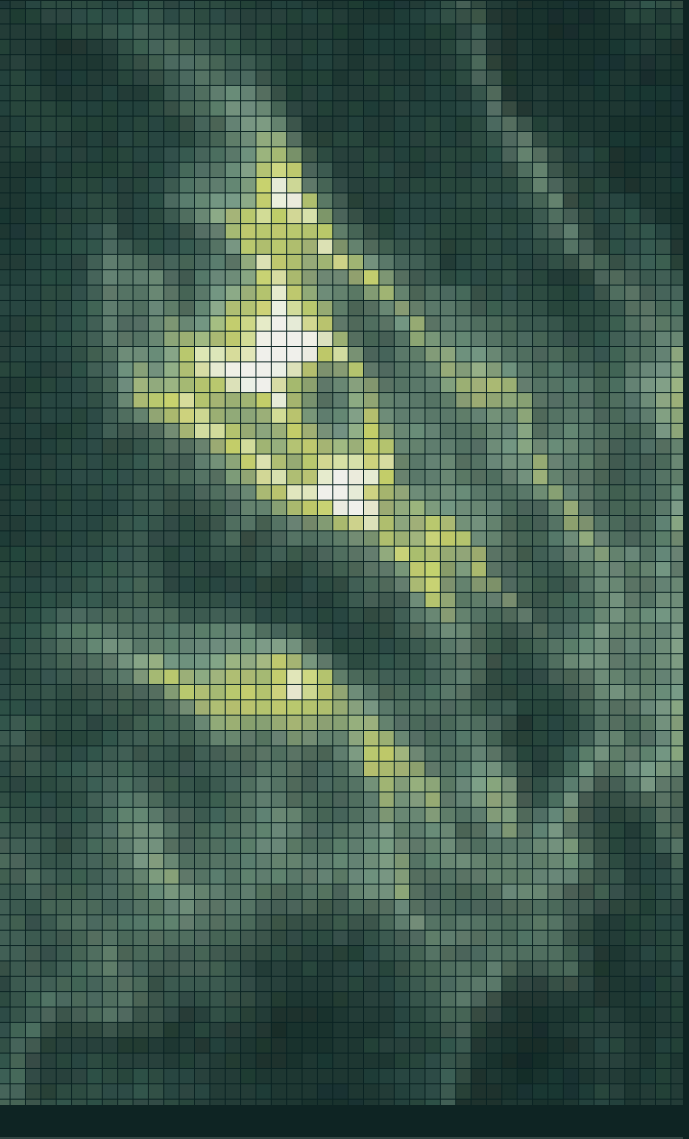
All four are generated from one illustrative terrain model. For client work, regenerate them from licensed elevation data for the actual property. They are never survey outputs.



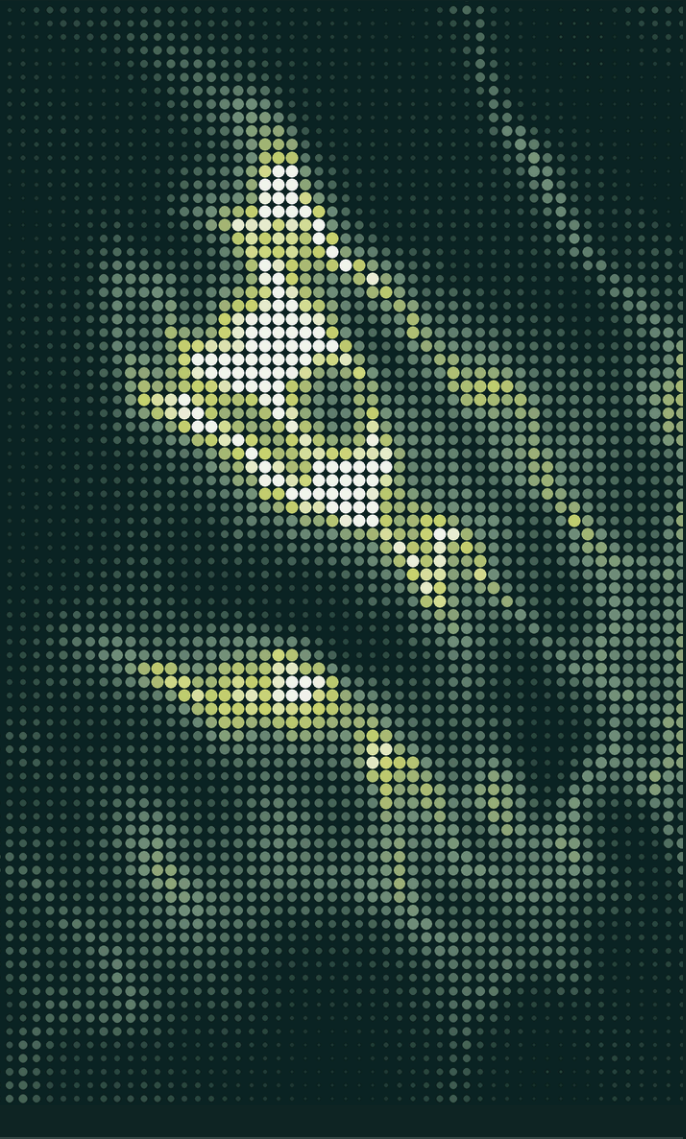
PIXEL RIDGELINES
Covers, hero images, motion.



BLOCK MODEL
Explaining method, reports.



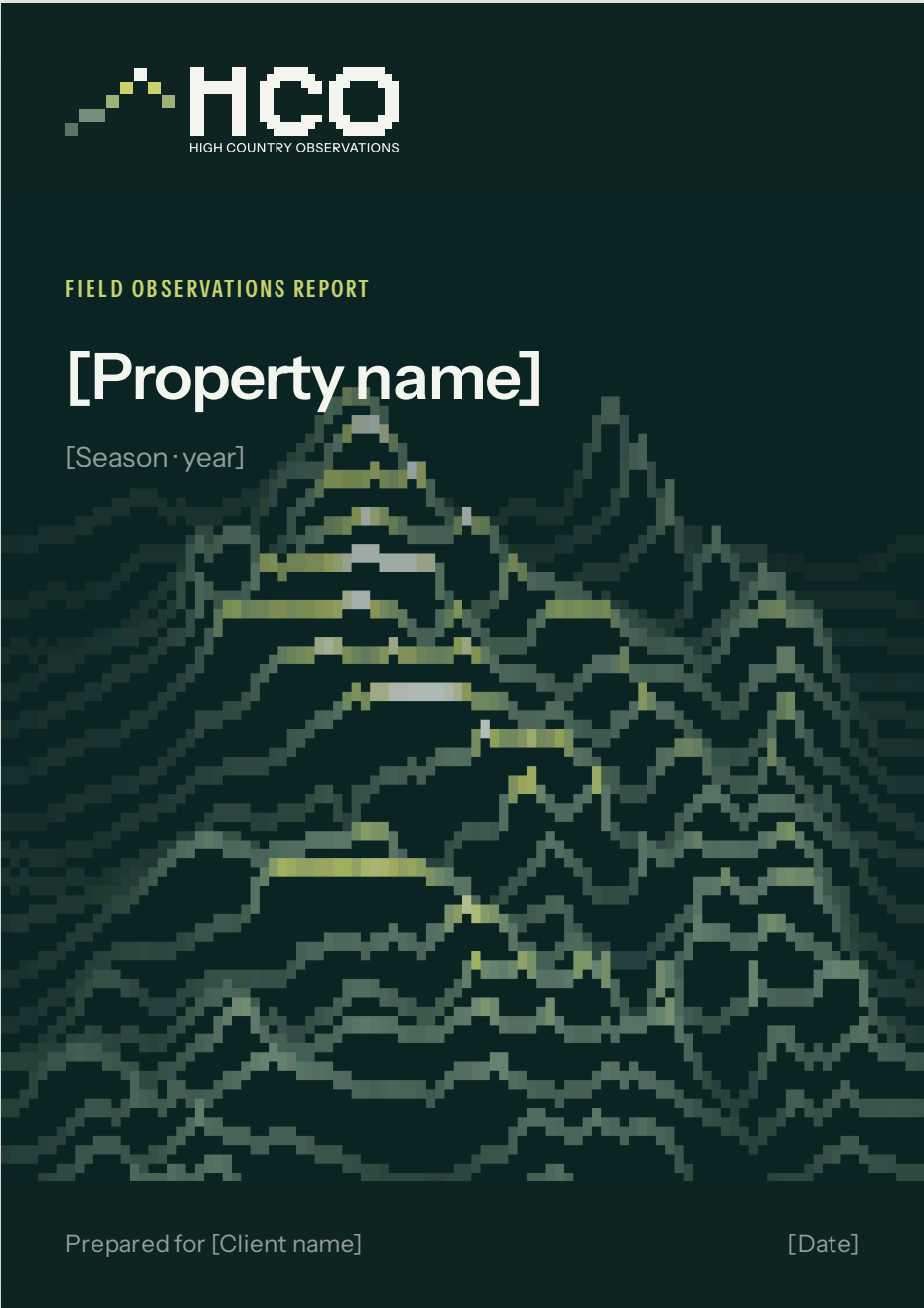
PIXEL MAP
Maps, report spreads, screens.



DOT MATRIX
Large formats, print texture.

Field report: cover and spread.

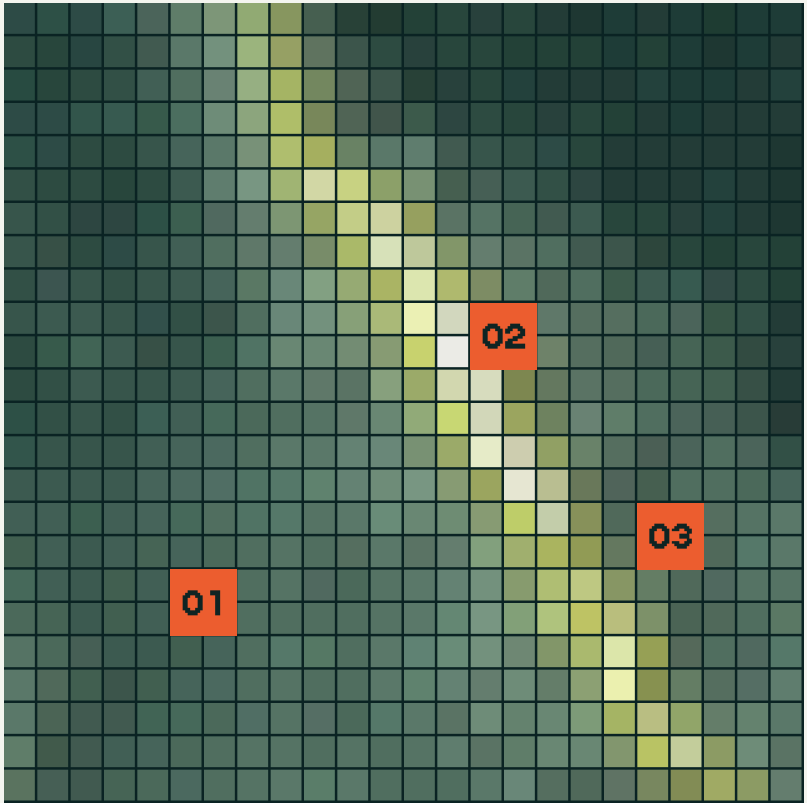
Sample content for layout only. The map, profile and observations are illustrative; no client, property or result is depicted.



HCO · FIELD OBSERVATIONS · [PROPERTY]

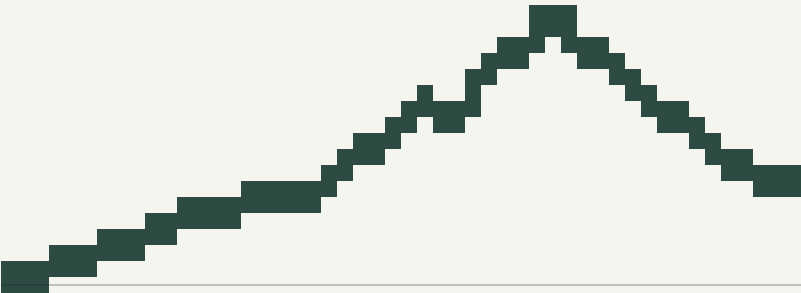
02 OBSERVATIONS

Three areas to look at first.



Map 1 · Illustrative terrain model, 24 × 24 cells. Not survey data.

SECTION A-A



- 01 Standing water after rain**
Lower boundary. Check the drainage line before the next irrigation cycle.
- 02 Uneven growth, north-east block**
Patchy canopy on the upper slope. Scout on foot to confirm the cause.
- 03 Gap in the fence line**
At the eastern gate. Repair before stock are moved.

Sample content for layout only

12 APPLICATIONS

Placeholders in brackets. No contact details are invented; real details are added once confirmed.

Stationery: letter, cards, signature.



[Address line 1]
[Address line 2]

[Date]

[Recipient name]
[Organisation]

Dear [Name],

[Phone] · [Email] · [Website]



Card · 85 × 55 mm · front



[Name]
[Role]

[Phone]
[Email]
[Website]

HIGH COUNTRY OBSERVATIONS

Back

New message

To [Recipient]

Subject [Subject]

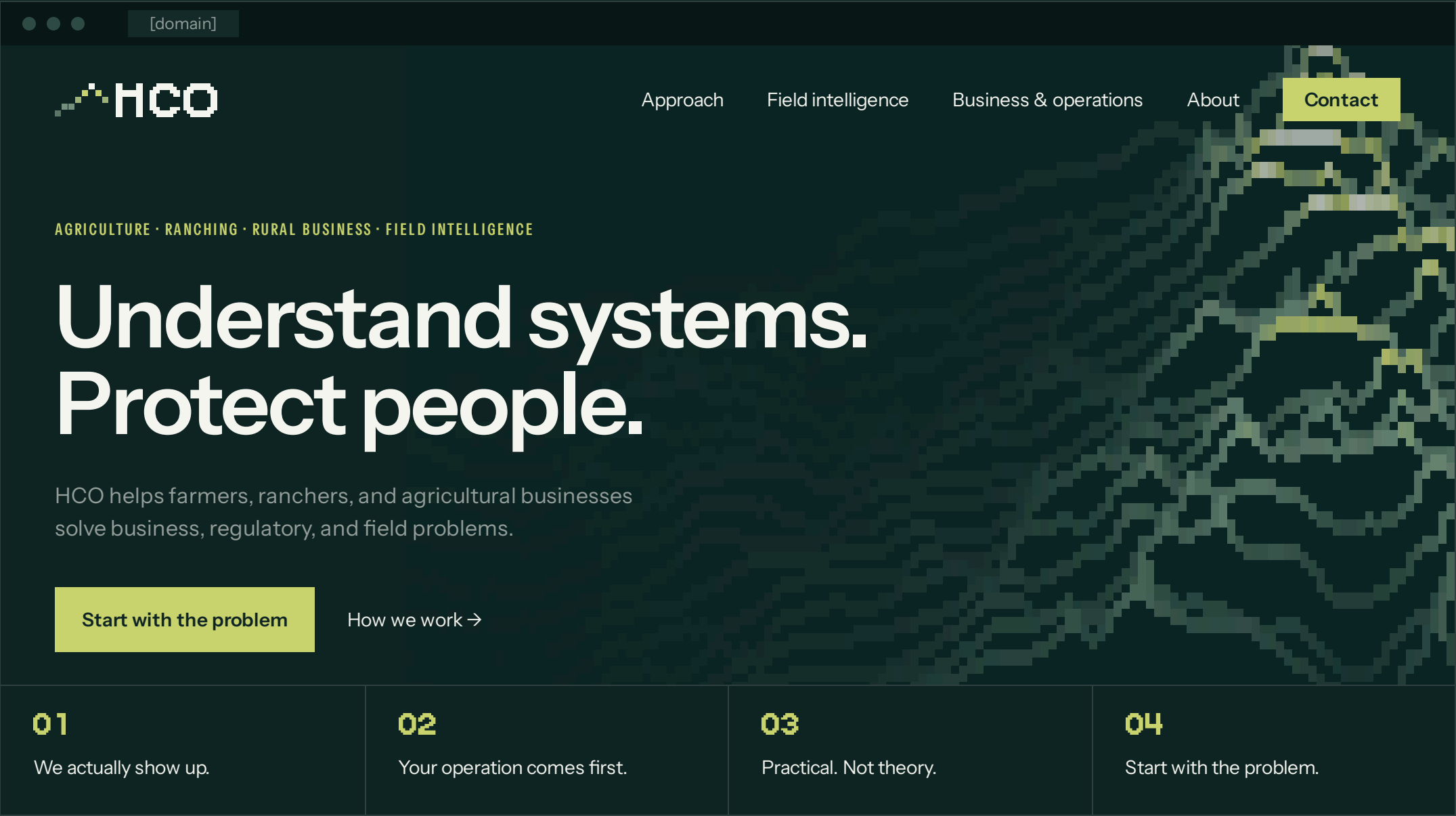


[Name]
[Role] · High Country Observations
[Phone] · [Email] · [Website]

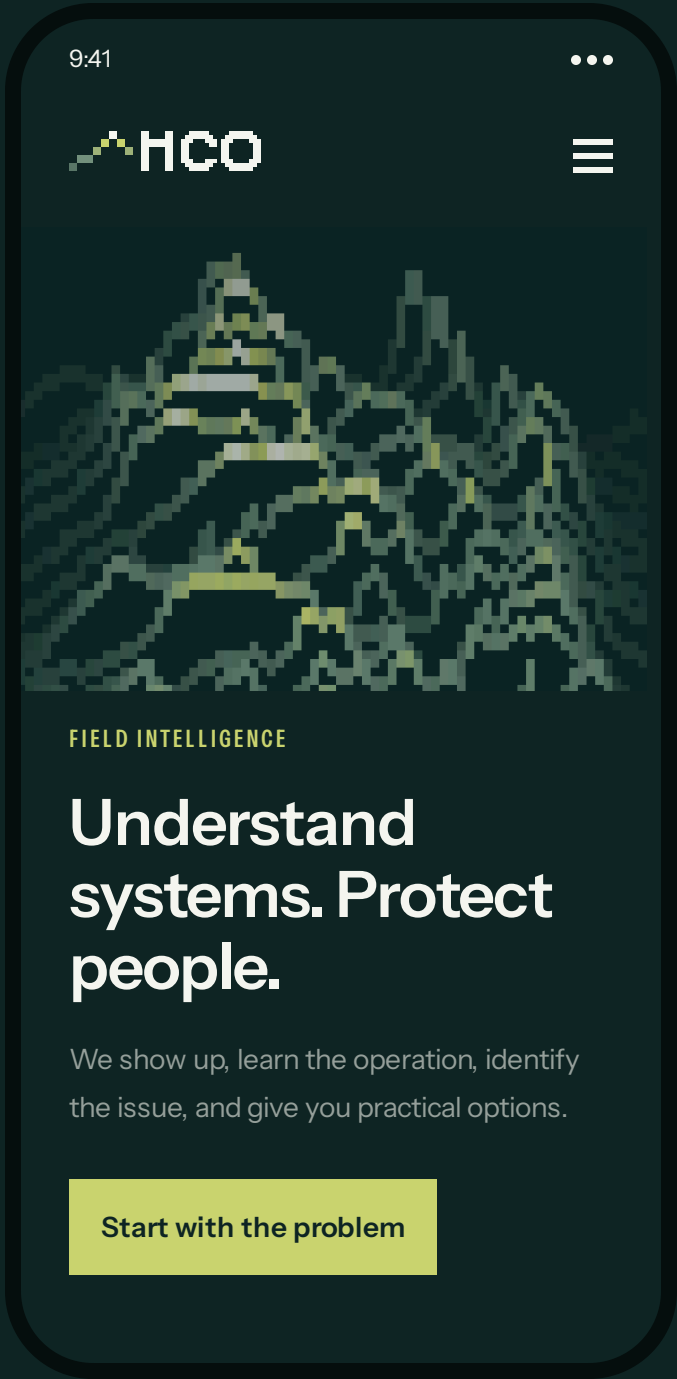
12 APPLICATIONS

Website: desktop and mobile.

Headline uses the optional line “Understand systems. Protect people.” Body copy and values are taken from the client’s flyer.



Desktop · 1440 px design width, shown at 75%



12 APPLICATIONS

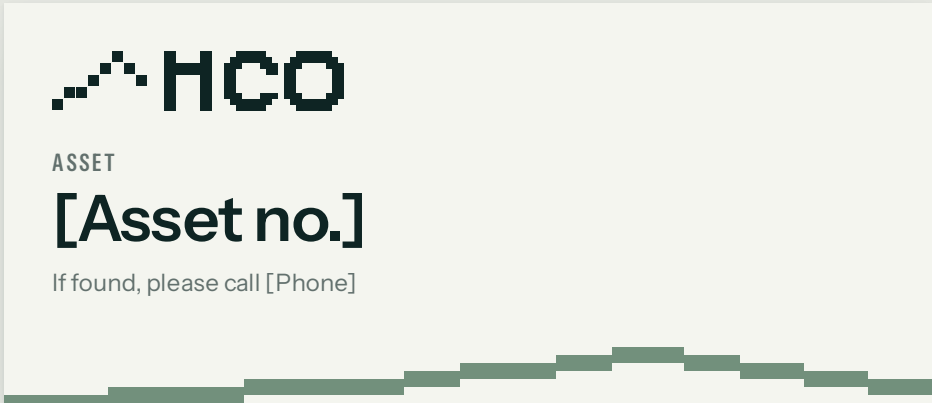
Field kit: vehicle, workwear, equipment.



VEHICLE DOOR
One-colour Basalt on light paint; the full-colour signature only on dark paint. Lockup about 600 mm wide on a 1 m door, clear of handles and seams.



EMBROIDERED PATCH
76 × 48 mm. Five thread colours on Basalt twill; descriptor omitted at this size.

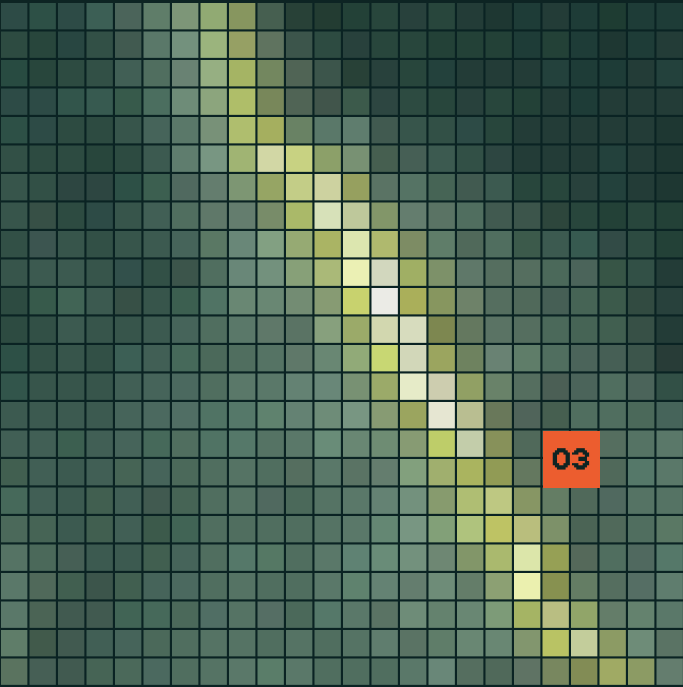


EQUIPMENT LABEL
For drone cases and field kit. Vinyl, 90 × 50 mm.

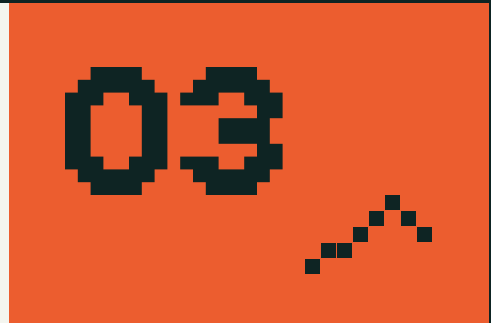
12 APPLICATIONS

The flag on the map is the
flag in the field.

Observation markers carry the number used
in the report, so a client can walk from the
page to the place. Flag is reserved for this one
job.



Map1·observation 03

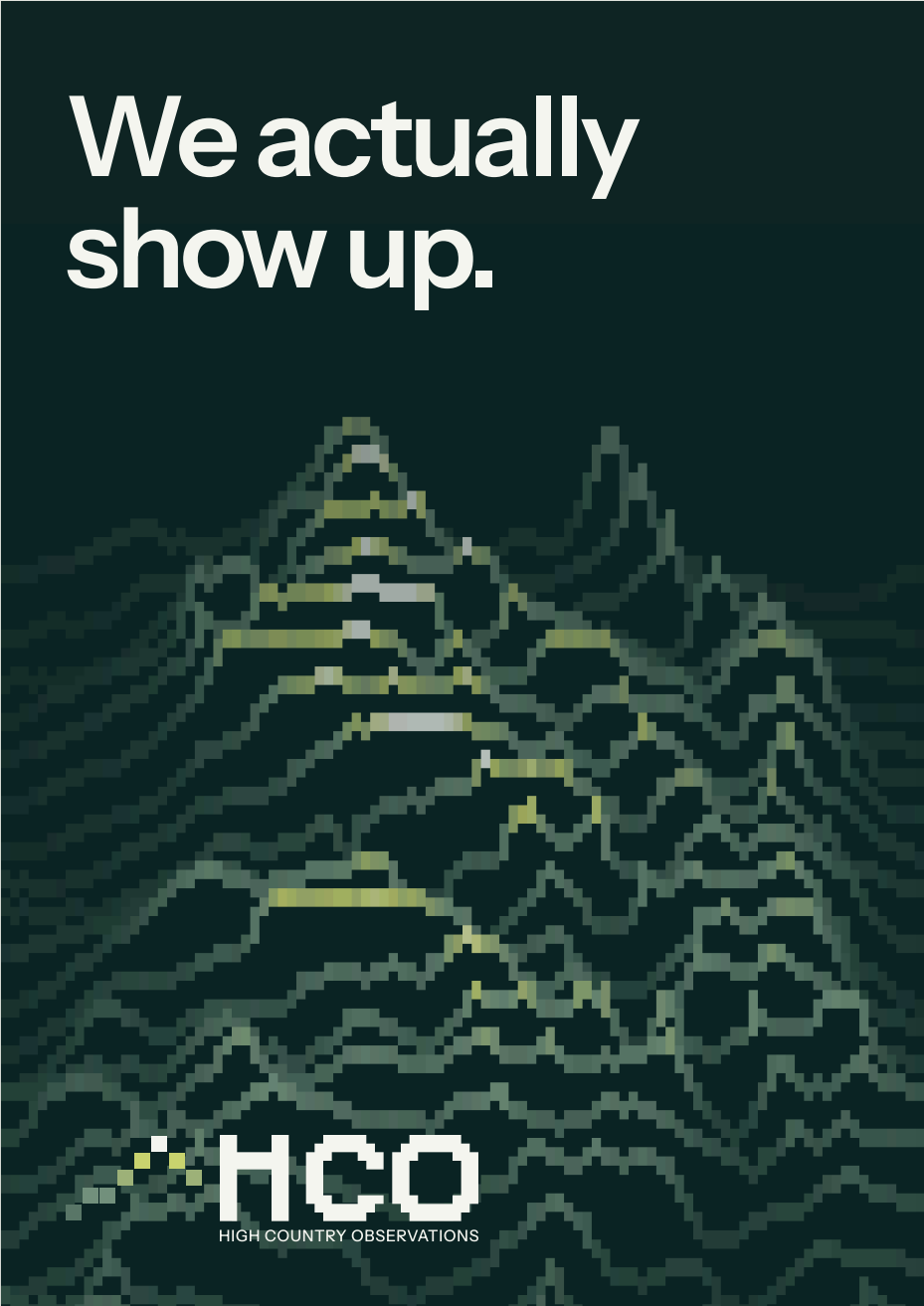


Marker flag·300 × 200 mm, on a 1 m
stake

12 APPLICATIONS

Posters, in the client’s own words.

Lines from the existing flyer. Pixel ridgelines, the symbol at scale, and a map with an observation.



13 DECISIONS

Six decisions before Stage 2.

01	Approve the direction Ridgeline symbol, pixel HCO and pixel numerals, for refinement in Stage 2.
02	Confirm the trading name The old logo says “Group”; the flyer says “Consulting”. The descriptor shows High Country Observations only until this is settled.
03	Choose the typeface Instrument Sans (open licence, no cost) or a licensed commercial grotesk. Licence terms are checked before release; no font files are distributed.
04	Decide on terrain data Keep the illustrative model, or supply a real area and licensed elevation data. Imagery is never presented as survey output.
05	Check the name and mark “High Country” is also used by others, including a Chevrolet Silverado trim and an outdoor retailer. Clearance needs a qualified trademark adviser.
06	Review resemblance Pixel wordmarks are common in technology brands. A resemblance search on the final artwork is part of Stage 2; it is not legal clearance.

STAGE 2 DELIVERS
Five-page identity summary, A4 landscape PDF
HCO-Brand-System.zip
logos/ — SVG, PDF and PNG, all versions
icons/ — 16, 32, 180 and 512 px
source/ — master artwork and build scripts
system/ — colour and type tokens, CSS and JSON
previews/ and README.md

